Jamie Trimmer

Senior Game Designer: Mission, Quest & Encounter Design

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Profile

Senior game designer with **18 years at Rockstar North**, the last seven as a designer on GTA Online and Red Dead Online, then GTA VI. Owns **mission, encounter and content design** from concept to shipped content, balancing pacing and player experience, scripting in visual tools and C#. Content played by **tens of millions of players**. Mentors junior designers and sets documentation standards.

Experience

Independent game development

November 2025 to present

- Building **engine proficiency** (**Unreal Engine 5 Blueprints**, Godot) through personal prototypes, each with a full design document: a ragdoll-physics combat game and a playable Snake variant with inverted growth mechanics, power-ups and split-screen play.

Support Worker, Community Integrated Care, Scottish Borders

March 2025 to present

- Provide personal and practical support to people in supported living services across several sites in the Scottish Borders.

Rockstar North, Edinburgh

Designer (2018 to 2025)

- **Mentored junior designers** and established **documentation standards and workflow practices**.

GTA VI

- Designed and implemented content for GTA VI using **more complex design and implementation methods**, including in-engine visual scripting and C#.
- **Extended existing systems** so iteration did not wait on engineering.

GTA Online and Red Dead Online (live multiplayer)

- Designed and delivered **well over 100 pieces of player-facing content** across multiple content packs and variations, in a core team of five embedded in a larger production.
- Solved a Red Dead Online **NPC budget ceiling** with a flagging system that cleaned up NPCs between mission phases. Missions felt significantly larger without extra budget, and the team adopted the approach as **standard practice**.
- Implemented content with authored gameplay data, in-game content creation tools and XML.
- Ran several pieces of content in parallel, managing cross-team dependencies against milestone deadlines.

Level Design Support, including Senior (2011 to 2018)

- Selected from QA to establish a new **embedded support team within the design department**, working directly with scripters and designers to prototype, test and refine gameplay systems and missions before wider QA integration.
- Gave hands-on playtesting and creative feedback during early implementation, and acted as the bridge between design and QA so features were stable before broader testing, **reducing iteration cycles**.
- Became a trusted point of contact for designers iterating on gameplay, resolving complex content issues independently and mentoring new team members on best practice and playtesting.

QA (2007 to 2011)

- Tested multiplayer and networked gameplay systems on **GTA IV**, identifying bugs and communicating issues clearly to development teams.
- Moved to playthrough testing on **GTA IV, LA Noire, Max Payne 3 and Red Dead Redemption**, finding critical path blockers and systemic issues. Clear, actionable bug reporting built working relationships with design and engineering and led to selection for the embedded Level Design Support role.

Skills

- Open world mission, quest and encounter design, and scripted player experiences
- Collaborating across design, art, engineering and production teams
- Mentoring junior designers and establishing workflow best practices
- Gameplay prototyping, whiteboxing and iterative design
- Playtesting methodology and bug triage
- Gameplay implementation using proprietary tools, in-engine visual scripting and C#
- Behaviour trees, state machines and data-driven content design
- Unreal Engine 5 Blueprints
- Production workflows and version control (Perforce, internal tools)
- Rapid adaptation to new tools and pipelines

Titles

Unreleased: GTA VI
Multiplayer: GTA Online, Red Dead Online
Earlier shipped titles: Red Dead Redemption 2, GTA V, Max Payne 3, LA Noire, Undead Nightmare, Red Dead Redemption, GTA IV and Episodes from Liberty City

Education

BSc (Combined Studies)
Heriot-Watt University